
How the six laboratories work

ORIGINAL ILLUSTRATIVE PLAY

These are original engine-assisted study continuations from this course's positions. They are not historical master games and no invented players or tournament results are assigned. The continuations reach roughly move twenty and stop for further practice.

THINK BEFORE REVEALING

At each checkpoint, name the opponent's threat, compare two candidates and calculate a forcing reply. Use a board to replay the sequence. The engine comparison supplies concrete evidence, while the opening explanation supplies a plan.

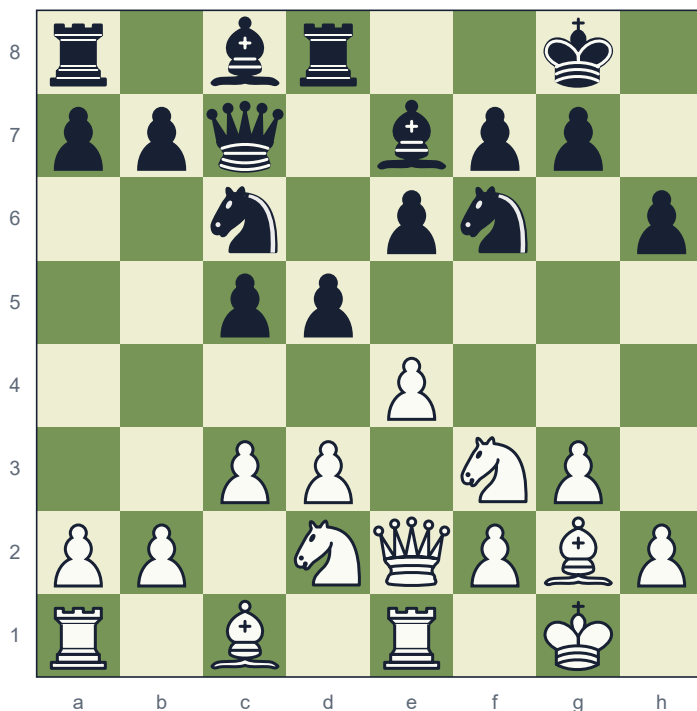
MORE THAN ONE GOOD MOVE

Close engine scores do not establish a unique answer. The finite search can prefer a different move when run longer. Accept another candidate if you can support it with a sound variation and a coherent explanation.

PRACTICE FROM BOTH SIDES

Play each starting position twice, switching colors. Record the first decision you could not explain and compare it with the branch lesson after the game.

KIA-LAB-01 / The core French-type position



Laboratory start - White to move

OPENING BACKGROUND

Re1 supports e4 and makes e5 more credible. Black has a broad d5-c5 center and may expand on the queenside while White builds a kingside initiative.

READ THE CURRENT POSITION

White king g1; central-file pawns f2, c3, d3, e4. Black king g8; central-file pawns c5, d5, e6, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

OPENING CONCERN TO RECHECK

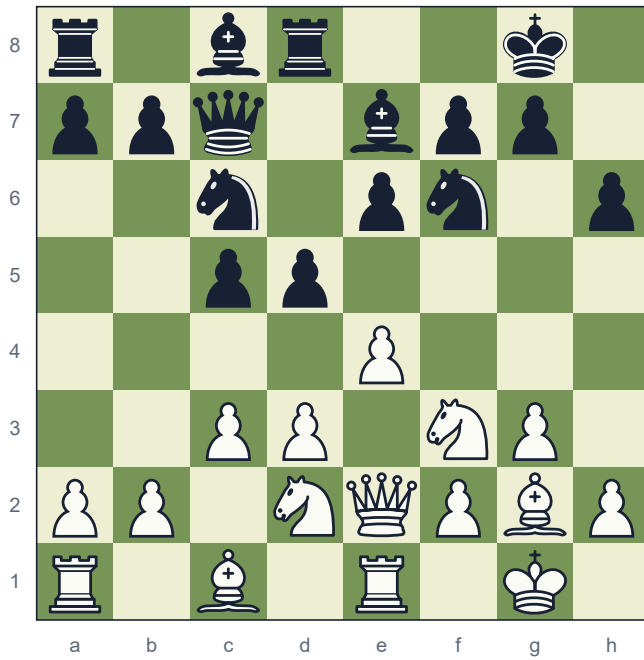
Black can play ...Qc7, ...b5 or ...dxe4. A kingside attack is premature if e4 can simply be captured. Decide which parts still apply after the moves already played.

BEFORE PLAYING

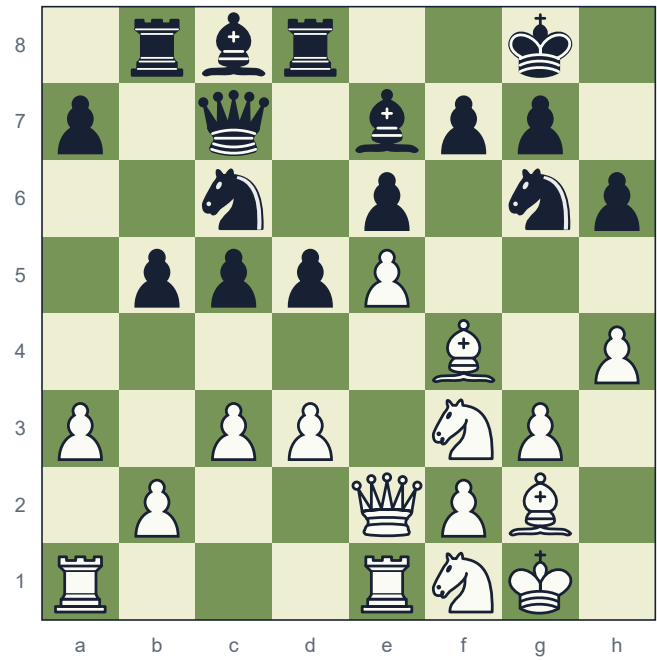
Write a candidate move and a reply for the opponent. Name the pawn break each side would like to achieve. The continuation on the following pages is one checked illustration, not a forced script.

KIA-LAB-01 / play and explain 1

11. a3 Rb8 12. e5 Nd7 13. Nf1 b5 14. Bf4 Nf8 15. h4 Ng6



Before this segment - White to move



After this segment - White to move

11. A3

Controls nearby wing squares and may restrain a piece or pawn. Compare this useful purpose with the time lost to central development.

13. NF1

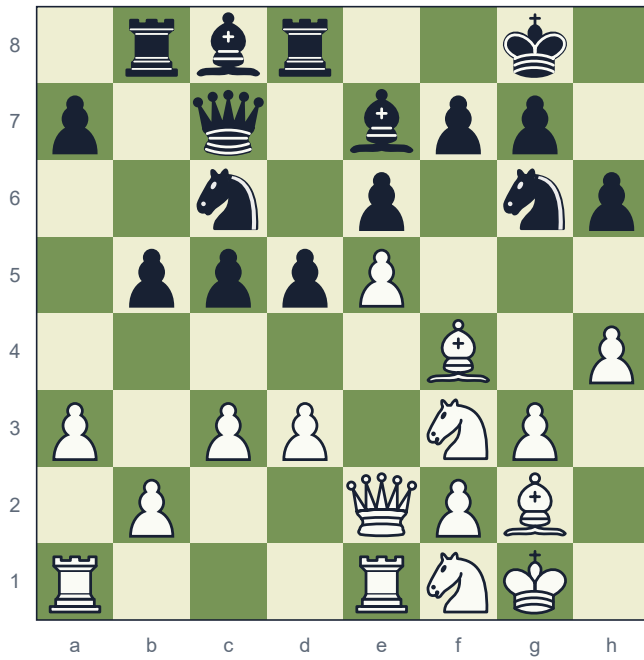
Places the knight on f1. Compare its activity and safety with its previous square, then use the branch explanation to connect the move to a plan.

REASSESS

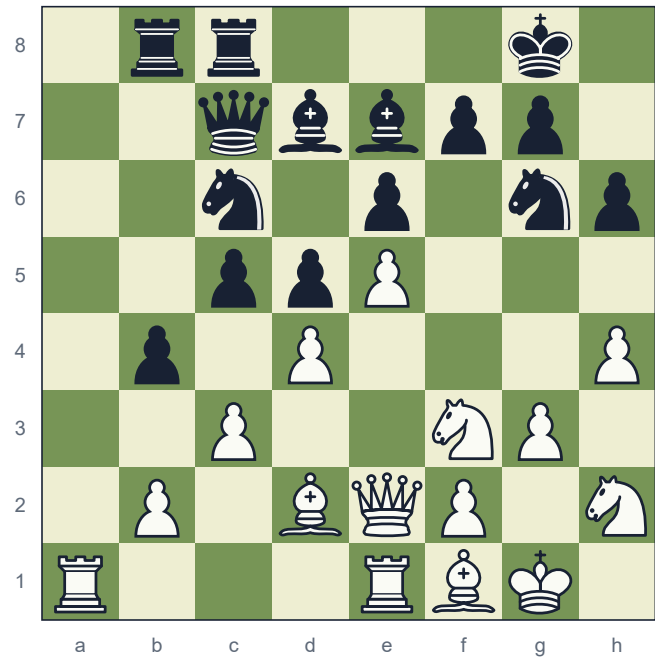
Name the material balance, the most active piece and the next pawn break. If the center changed, explain why the original plan may need to change too.

KIA-LAB-01 / play and explain 2

16. Bd2 a5 17. N1h2 b4 18. axb4 axb4 19. d4 Bd7 20. Bf1 Rdc8



Before this segment - White to move



After this segment - White to move

16. BD2

Places the bishop on d2. Compare its activity and safety with its previous square, then use the branch explanation to connect the move to a plan.

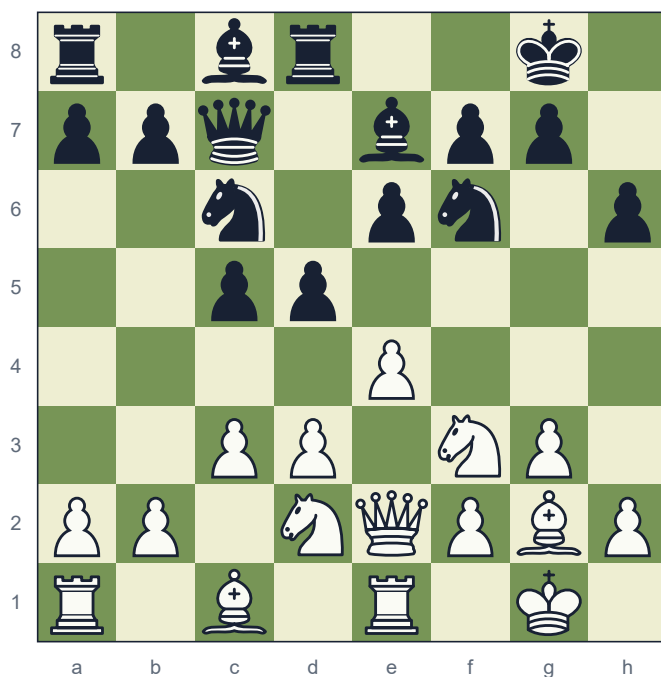
18. AXB4

The pawn captures a pawn on b4. Calculate the best reply before assuming a recapture, then recount material and opened lines.

REASSESS

Name the material balance, the most active piece and the next pawn break. If the center changed, explain why the original plan may need to change too.

KIA-LAB-01 / decision 1



White to move

COMPARE CANDIDATES

a3 and a4. Before reading the continuations, explain a useful purpose for each and calculate the opponent's most forcing reply.

CURRENT POSITION

White king g1; central-file pawns f2, c3, d3, e4. Black king g8; central-file pawns c5, d5, e6, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

CANDIDATE A3

11. a3 Rb8 12. d4 cxd4 13. Nxd4 Nxd4 14. cxd4 dxe4 Search estimate: -0.06 from White's perspective.

CANDIDATE A4

11. a4 Search estimate: -0.08 from White's perspective.

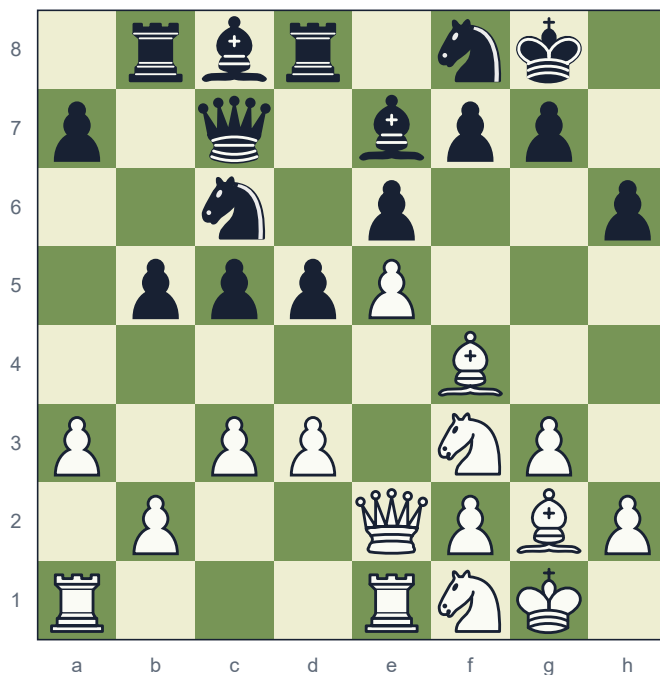
EXPLAIN THE PREFERRED MOVE

Controls nearby wing squares and may restrain a piece or pawn. Compare this useful purpose with the time lost to central development.

HOW TO INTERPRET THIS

The scores compare these candidates in one finite search. Close values mean the explanation and practical comfort matter; they do not imply a unique winning move. Replay both lines and identify the first concrete difference.

KIA-LAB-01 / decision 2



COMPARE CANDIDATES

h4 and d4. Before reading the continuations, explain a useful purpose for each and calculate the opponent's most forcing reply.

CURRENT POSITION

White king g1; central-file pawns f2, c3, d3, e5. Black king g8; central-file pawns c5, d5, e6, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

CANDIDATE H4

15. h4 Search estimate: +0.24 from White's perspective.

CANDIDATE D4

15. d4 cxd4 16. Nxd4 Nxd4 17. cxd4 b4 18. axb4 Bxb4 Search estimate: -0.04 from White's perspective.

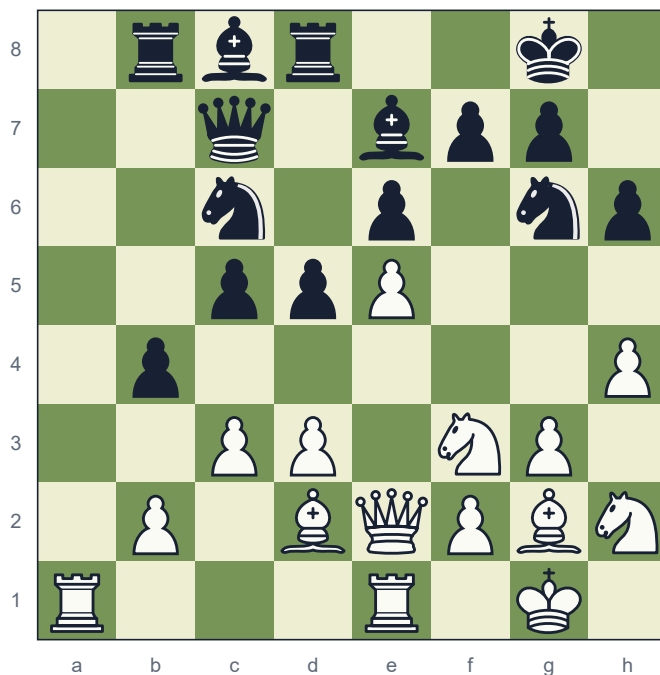
EXPLAIN THE PREFERRED MOVE

Creates a wing or central pawn contact and changes king shelter. Calculate captures and the opponent's central counterplay before extending the advance.

HOW TO INTERPRET THIS

The scores compare these candidates in one finite search. Close values mean the explanation and practical comfort matter; they do not imply a unique winning move. Replay both lines and identify the first concrete difference.

KIA-LAB-01 / decision 3



White to move

COMPARE CANDIDATES

d4 and h5. Before reading the continuations, explain a useful purpose for each and calculate the opponent's most forcing reply.

CURRENT POSITION

White king g1; central-file pawns f2, c3, d3, e5. Black king g8; central-file pawns c5, d5, e6, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

CANDIDATE D4

19. d4 Bd7 20. h5 Nf8 21. Ng4 bxc3 22. bxc3 cxd4 Search estimate: +0.18 from White's perspective.

CANDIDATE H5

19. h5 Search estimate: +0.17 from White's perspective.

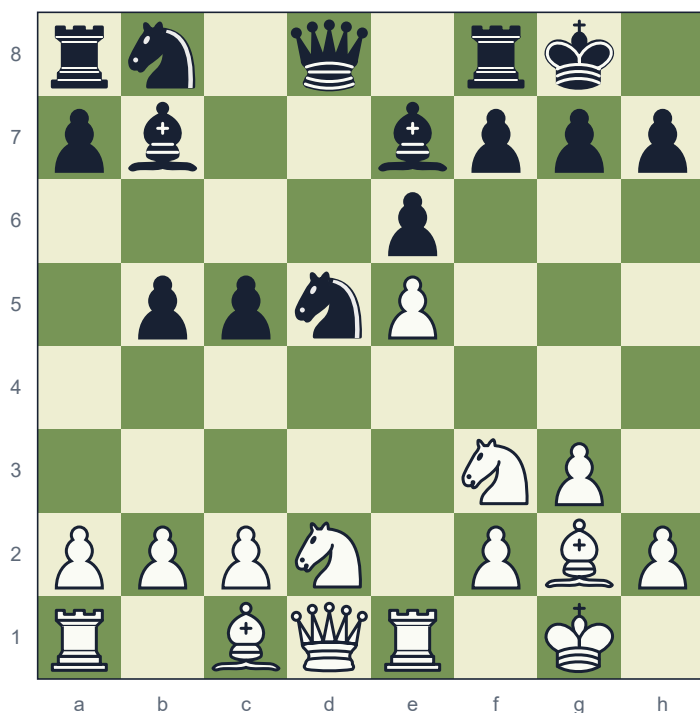
EXPLAIN THE PREFERRED MOVE

Changes central space and pawn contacts. Calculate captures, advances and maintaining tension before choosing the next piece plan.

HOW TO INTERPRET THIS

The scores compare these candidates in one finite search. Close values mean the explanation and practical comfort matter; they do not imply a unique winning move. Replay both lines and identify the first concrete difference.

KIA-LAB-02 / Black exchanges on e4



Laboratory start - White to move

OPENING BACKGROUND

The central exchange removes the familiar d5-e5 blockade. White's d-pawn becomes an e-pawn, opening the d-file and changing the bishop's prospects.

READ THE CURRENT POSITION

White king g1; central-file pawns c2, f2, e5. Black king g8; central-file pawns c5, e6, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

OPENING CONCERN TO RECHECK

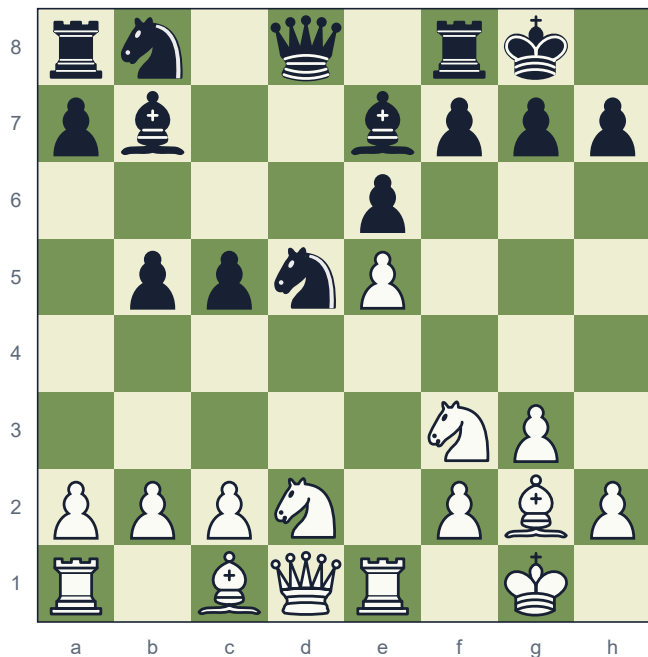
An automatic e5 attack plan may no longer fit. Black can use ...Nc6 and ...Qc7 to put pressure on e4. Decide which parts still apply after the moves already played.

BEFORE PLAYING

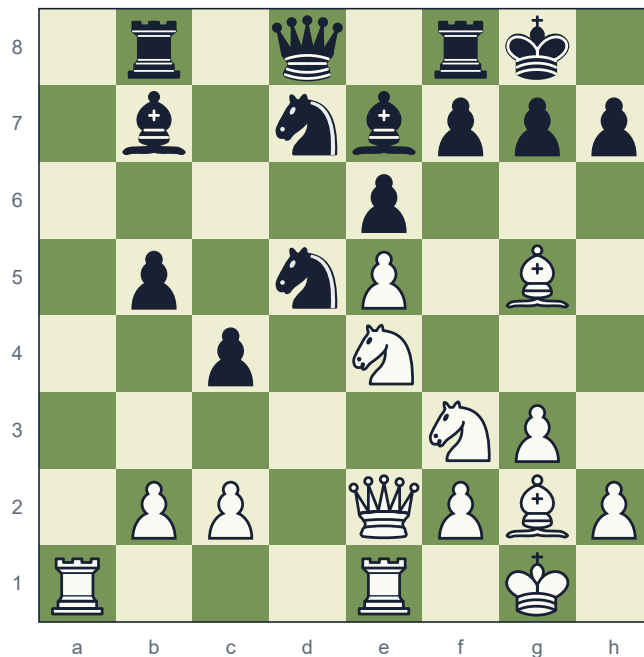
Write a candidate move and a reply for the opponent. Name the pawn break each side would like to achieve. The continuation on the following pages is one checked illustration, not a forced script.

KIA-LAB-02 / play and explain 1

11. Qe2 c4 12. Ne4 Nd7 13. a4 a6 14. Bg5 Rb8 15. axb5 axb5



Before this segment - White to move



After this segment - White to move

11. Qe2

Places the queen on e2. Compare its activity and safety with its previous square, then use the branch explanation to connect the move to a plan.

13. A4

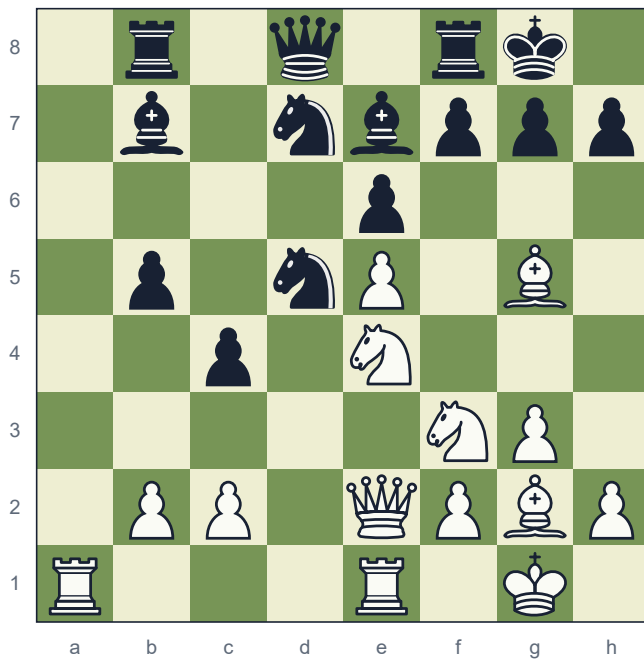
Places the pawn on a4. Compare its activity and safety with its previous square, then use the branch explanation to connect the move to a plan.

REASSESS

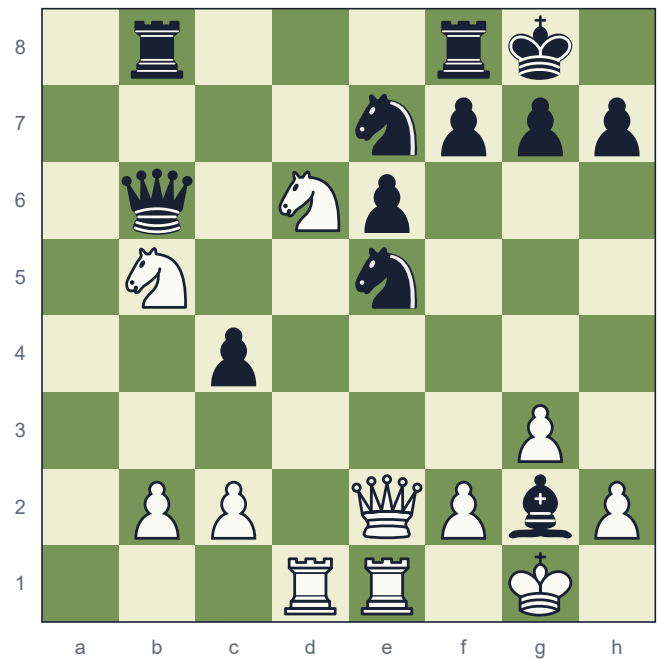
Name the material balance, the most active piece and the next pawn break. If the center changed, explain why the original plan may need to change too.

KIA-LAB-02 / play and explain 2

16. Rad1 Qc7 17. Nd4 Nxe5 18. Bxe7 Nxe7 19. Nxb5 Qb6 20. Ned6 Bxg2



Before this segment - White to move



After this segment - White to move

16. RAD1

Places the rook on d1, attacking knight on d5. A legal capture may still be unsound if the target is defended.

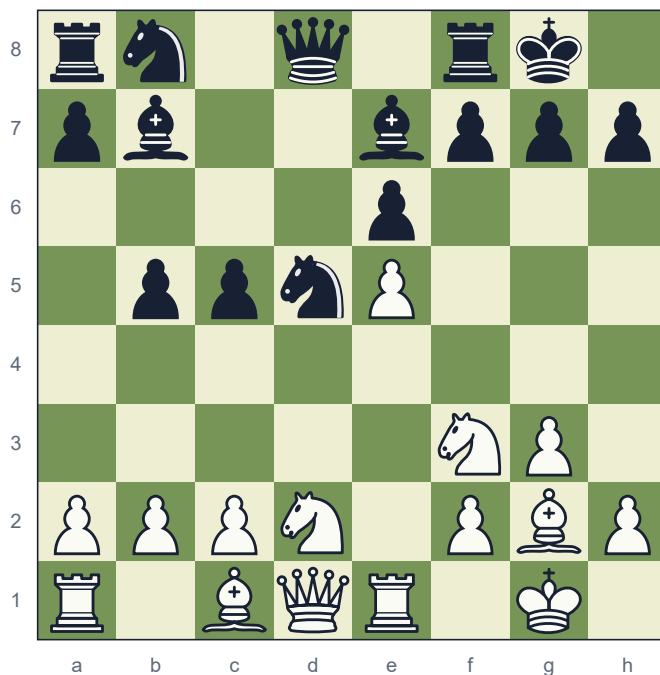
18. BXE7

The bishop captures a bishop on e7. Calculate the best reply before assuming a recapture, then recount material and opened lines.

REASSESS

Name the material balance, the most active piece and the next pawn break. If the center changed, explain why the original plan may need to change too.

KIA-LAB-02 / decision 1



COMPARE CANDIDATES

Qe2 and Ne4. Before reading the continuations, explain a useful purpose for each and calculate the opponent's most forcing reply.

CURRENT POSITION

White king g1; central-file pawns c2, f2, e5. Black king g8; central-file pawns c5, e6, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

CANDIDATE QE2

11. Qe2 Search estimate: +0.32 from White's perspective.

CANDIDATE NE4

11. Ne4 Nd7 12. Qe2 c4 13. Bg5 Qb6 14. Bxe7 Nxe7 Search estimate: +0.26 from White's perspective.

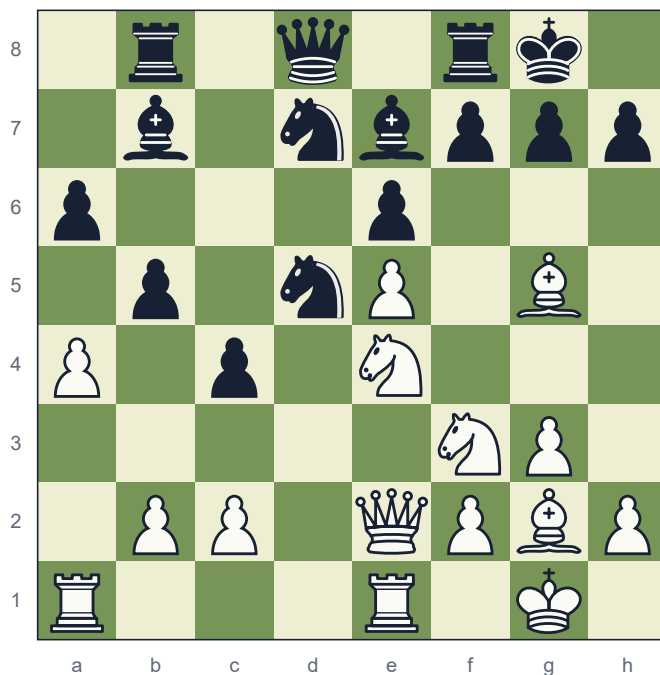
EXPLAIN THE PREFERRED MOVE

Places the queen on e2. Compare its activity and safety with its previous square, then use the branch explanation to connect the move to a plan.

HOW TO INTERPRET THIS

The scores compare these candidates in one finite search. Close values mean the explanation and practical comfort matter; they do not imply a unique winning move. Replay both lines and identify the first concrete difference.

KIA-LAB-02 / decision 2



COMPARE CANDIDATES

axb5 and Rad1. Before reading the continuations, explain a useful purpose for each and calculate the opponent's most forcing reply.

CURRENT POSITION

White king g1; central-file pawns c2, f2, e5. Black king g8; central-file pawns c4, e6, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

CANDIDATE AXB5

15. axb5 axb5 16. Rad1 Qc7 17. Nd4 Nxe5 18. Nxb5 Qb6 Search estimate: +0.12 from White's perspective.

CANDIDATE RAD1

15. Rad1 Bxg5 Search estimate: +0.05 from White's perspective.

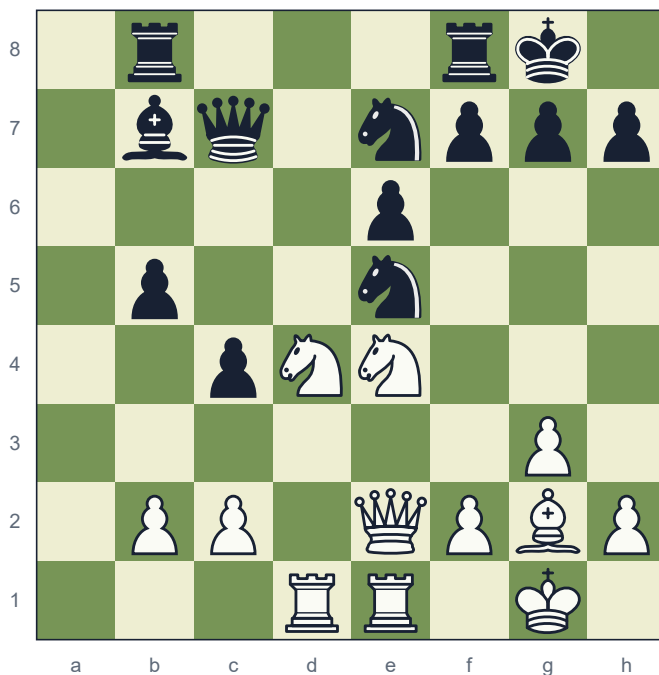
EXPLAIN THE PREFERRED MOVE

The pawn captures a pawn on b5. Calculate the best reply before assuming a recapture, then recount material and opened lines.

HOW TO INTERPRET THIS

The scores compare these candidates in one finite search. Close values mean the explanation and practical comfort matter; they do not imply a unique winning move. Replay both lines and identify the first concrete difference.

KIA-LAB-02 / decision 3



White to move

COMPARE CANDIDATES

Nxb5 and h4. Before reading the continuations, explain a useful purpose for each and calculate the opponent's most forcing reply.

CURRENT POSITION

White king g1; central-file pawns c2, f2. Black king g8; central-file pawns c4, e6, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

CANDIDATE NXB5

19. Nxb5 Qb6 20. Ned6 Bxg2 21. Kxg2 Qc6+ 22. Qe4 Rfd8 Search estimate: -0.08 from White's perspective.

CANDIDATE H4

19. h4 Qb6 20. Nxb5 Qxb5 21. Nd6 Bf3 22. Bxf3 Nxf3+ Search estimate: -0.27 from White's perspective.

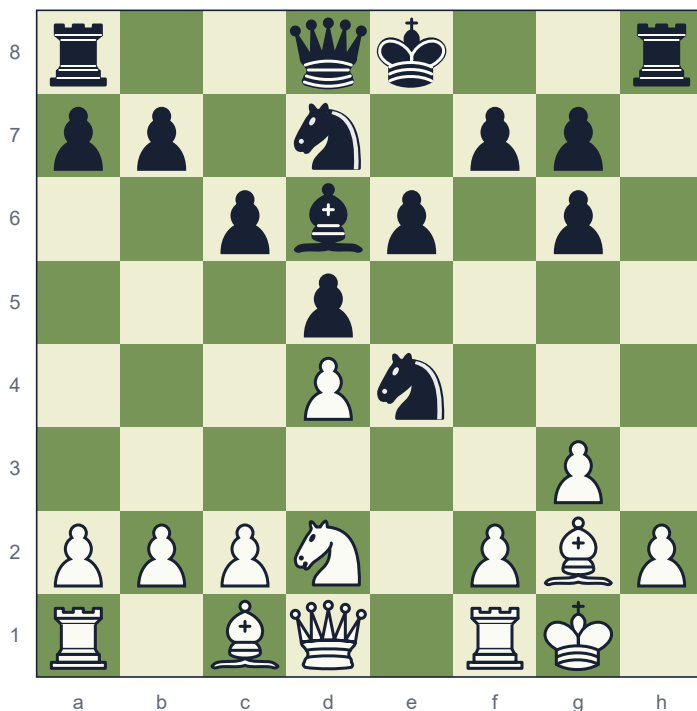
EXPLAIN THE PREFERRED MOVE

The knight captures a pawn on b5. Calculate the best reply before assuming a recapture, then recount material and opened lines.

HOW TO INTERPRET THIS

The scores compare these candidates in one finite search. Close values mean the explanation and practical comfort matter; they do not imply a unique winning move. Replay both lines and identify the first concrete difference.

KIA-LAB-03 / Questioning Bf5 with Nh4



Laboratory start - White to move

OPENING BACKGROUND

White gives a knight for the active bishop and changes Black's kingside pawn structure. The open h-file can help Black as well as create targets.

READ THE CURRENT POSITION

White king g1; central-file pawns c2, f2, d4. Black king e8; central-file pawns d5, c6, e6, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

OPENING CONCERN TO RECHECK

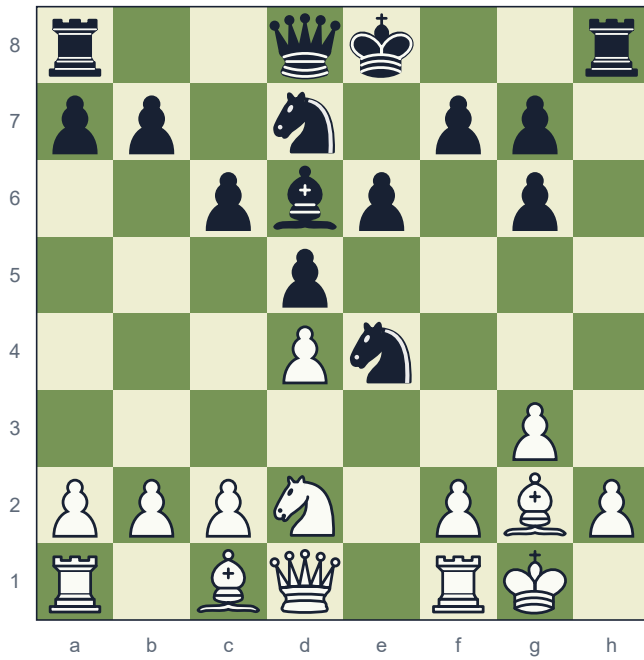
Black's h8 rook now has an open file. Castling short was already a commitment, so watch pressure toward your own king. Decide which parts still apply after the moves already played.

BEFORE PLAYING

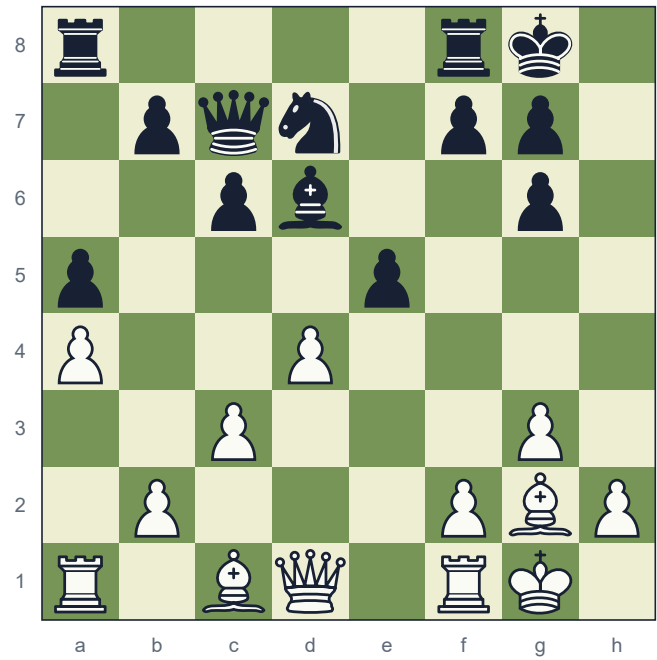
Write a candidate move and a reply for the opponent. Name the pawn break each side would like to achieve. The continuation on the following pages is one checked illustration, not a forced script.

KIA-LAB-03 / play and explain 1

11. Nxe4 dxe4 12. Bxe4 O-O 13. c3 Qc7 14. a4 e5 15. Bg2 a5



Before this segment - White to move



After this segment - White to move

11. Nxe4

The knight captures a knight on e4. Calculate the best reply before assuming a recapture, then recount material and opened lines.

13. c3

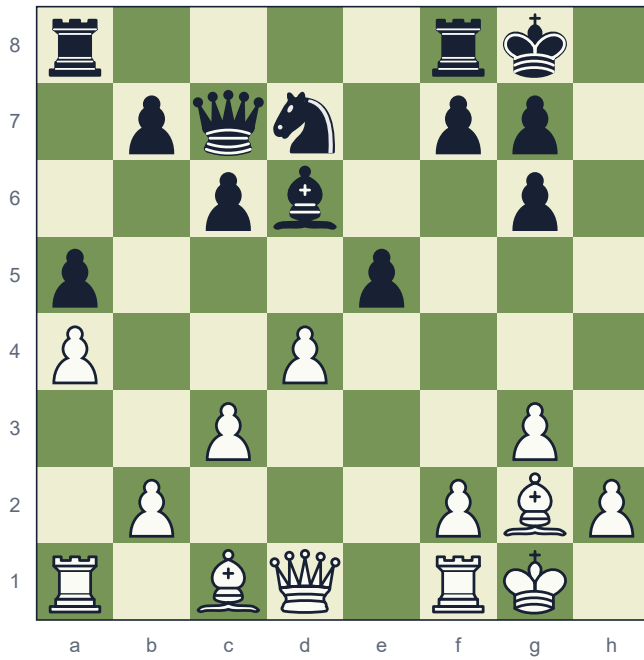
Places the pawn on c3. Compare its activity and safety with its previous square, then use the branch explanation to connect the move to a plan.

REASSESS

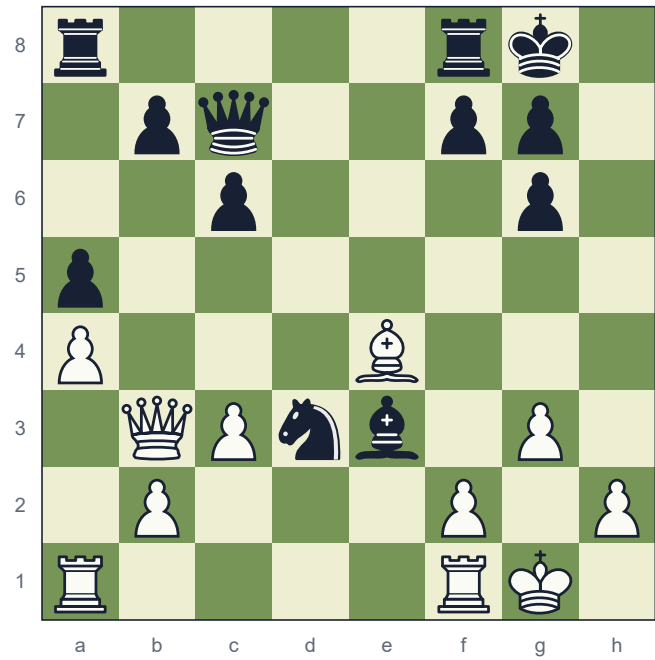
Name the material balance, the most active piece and the next pawn break. If the center changed, explain why the original plan may need to change too.

KIA-LAB-03 / play and explain 2

16. dxe5 Nxe5 17. Qb3 Nd3 18. Bg5 Be7 19. Be3 Bc5 20. Be4 Bxe3



Before this segment - White to move



After this segment - White to move

16. DXE5

The pawn captures a pawn on e5. Calculate the best reply before assuming a recapture, then recount material and opened lines.

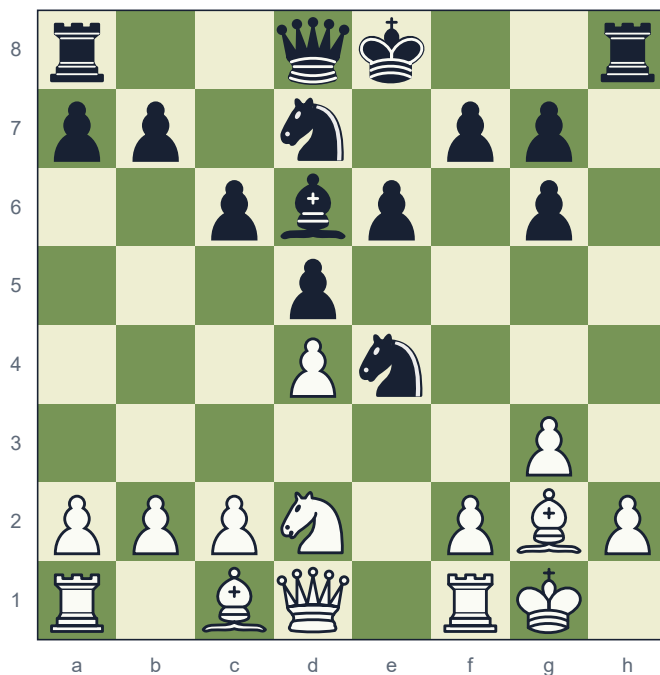
18. BG5

Places the bishop on g5. Compare its activity and safety with its previous square, then use the branch explanation to connect the move to a plan.

REASSESS

Name the material balance, the most active piece and the next pawn break. If the center changed, explain why the original plan may need to change too.

KIA-LAB-03 / decision 1



White to move

COMPARE CANDIDATES

Nxe4 and Bxe4. Before reading the continuations, explain a useful purpose for each and calculate the opponent's most forcing reply.

CURRENT POSITION

White king g1; central-file pawns c2, f2, d4. Black king e8; central-file pawns d5, c6, e6, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

CANDIDATE NXE4

11. Nxe4 Search estimate: +0.56 from White's perspective.

CANDIDATE BXE4

11. Bxe4 dxe4 12. Nxe4 Nf6 13. Re1 O-O 14. c3 Be7 Search estimate: +0.21 from White's perspective.

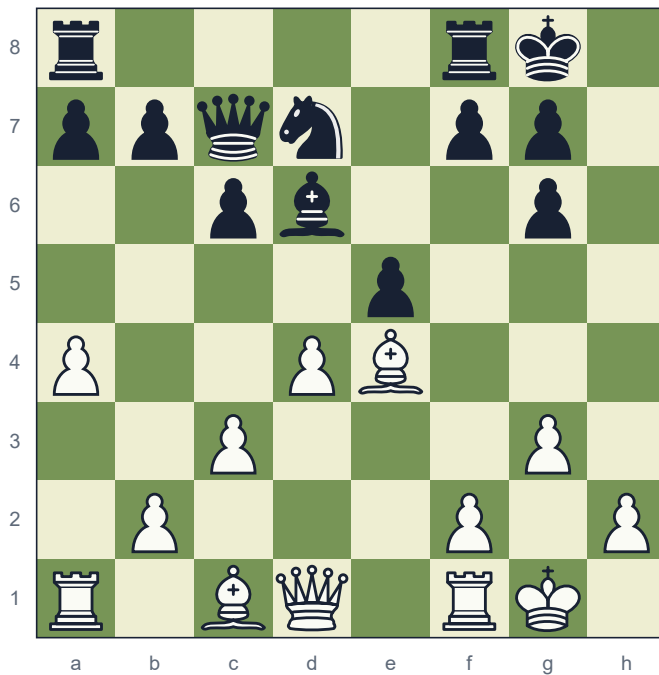
EXPLAIN THE PREFERRED MOVE

The knight captures a knight on e4. Calculate the best reply before assuming a recapture, then recount material and opened lines.

HOW TO INTERPRET THIS

The scores compare these candidates in one finite search. Close values mean the explanation and practical comfort matter; they do not imply a unique winning move. Replay both lines and identify the first concrete difference.

KIA-LAB-03 / decision 2



COMPARE CANDIDATES

Bg2 and a5. Before reading the continuations, explain a useful purpose for each and calculate the opponent's most forcing reply.

CURRENT POSITION

White king g1; central-file pawns f2, c3, d4. Black king g8; central-file pawns e5, c6, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

CANDIDATE BG2

15. Bg2 Rfe8 Search estimate: +0.51 from White's perspective.

CANDIDATE A5

15. a5 Rfe8 16. Bg2 a6 17. Bg5 Be7 18. Be3 exd4 Search estimate: +0.51 from White's perspective.

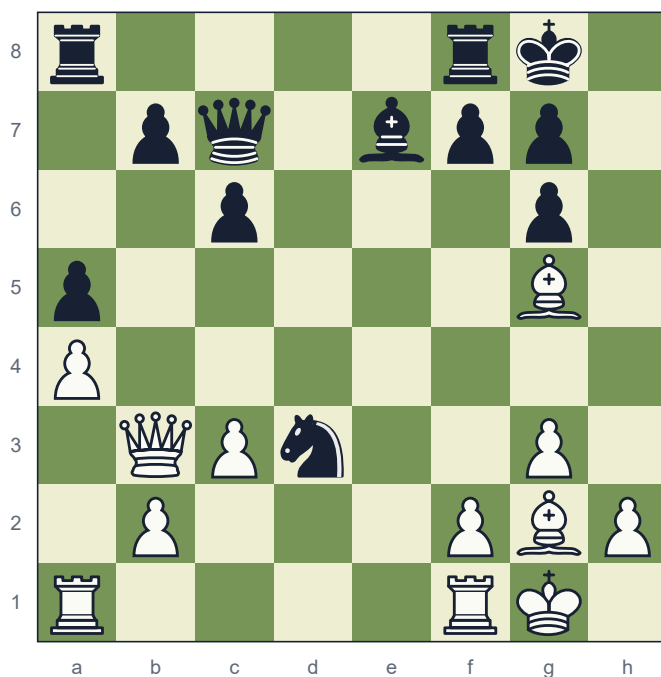
EXPLAIN THE PREFERRED MOVE

Completes the kingside fianchetto. Trace the diagonal to its first blocker; the bishop cannot attack through friendly pawns or pieces.

HOW TO INTERPRET THIS

The scores compare these candidates in one finite search. Close values mean the explanation and practical comfort matter; they do not imply a unique winning move. Replay both lines and identify the first concrete difference.

KIA-LAB-03 / decision 3



White to move

COMPARE CANDIDATES

Be3 and Rad1. Before reading the continuations, explain a useful purpose for each and calculate the opponent's most forcing reply.

CURRENT POSITION

White king g1; central-file pawns f2, c3. Black king g8; central-file pawns c6, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

CANDIDATE BE3

19. Be3 Bc5 20. Be4 Bxe3 21. Bxd3 Ba7 22. Bxg6 Rad8 Search estimate: +0.47 from White's perspective.

CANDIDATE RAD1

19. Rad1 Nc5 Search estimate: +0.13 from White's perspective.

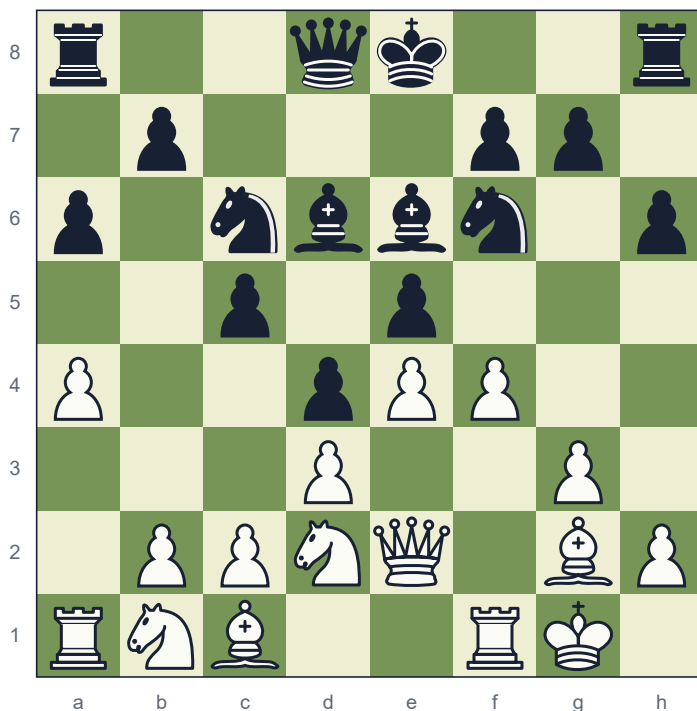
EXPLAIN THE PREFERRED MOVE

Places the bishop on e3. Compare its activity and safety with its previous square, then use the branch explanation to connect the move to a plan.

HOW TO INTERPRET THIS

The scores compare these candidates in one finite search. Close values mean the explanation and practical comfort matter; they do not imply a unique winning move. Replay both lines and identify the first concrete difference.

KIA-LAB-04 / Reversed King's Indian structure



Laboratory start - White to move

OPENING BACKGROUND

Black closes the center with a space advantage. White has a reversed King's Indian type of position, but the move order and extra tempo require independent calculation.

READ THE CURRENT POSITION

White king g1; central-file pawns c2, d3, e4, f4. Black king e8; central-file pawns d4, c5, e5, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

OPENING CONCERN TO RECHECK

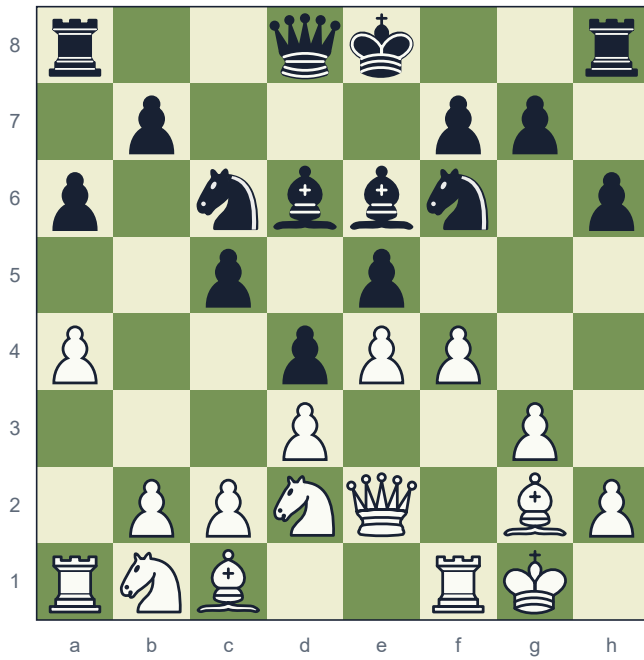
Black can expand with ...b5 and ...c4. A slow maneuver must be measured against the opponent's actual pawn-break timing. Decide which parts still apply after the moves already played.

BEFORE PLAYING

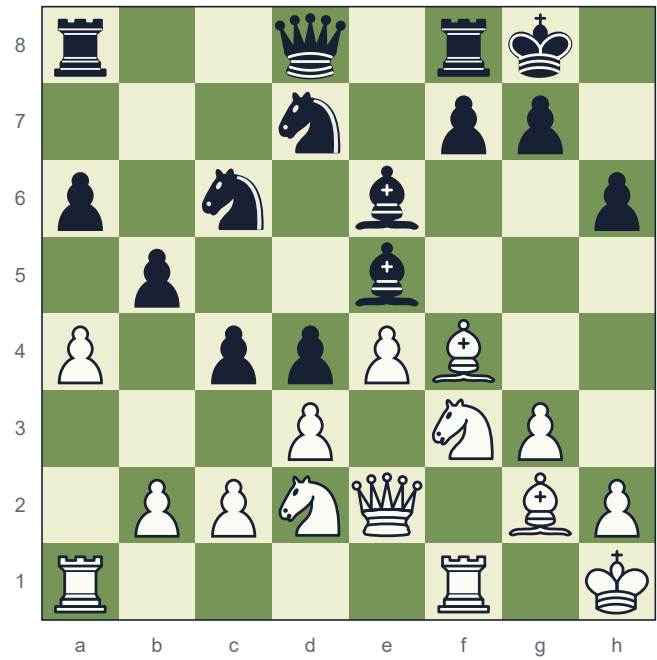
Write a candidate move and a reply for the opponent. Name the pawn break each side would like to achieve. The continuation on the following pages is one checked illustration, not a forced script.

KIA-LAB-04 / play and explain 1

11. Kh1 b5 12. Nf3 c4 13. fxe5 Bxe5 14. Bf4 Nd7 15. Nbd2 O-O



Before this segment - White to move



After this segment - White to move

11. KH1

Places the king on h1. Compare its activity and safety with its previous square, then use the branch explanation to connect the move to a plan.

13. FXE5

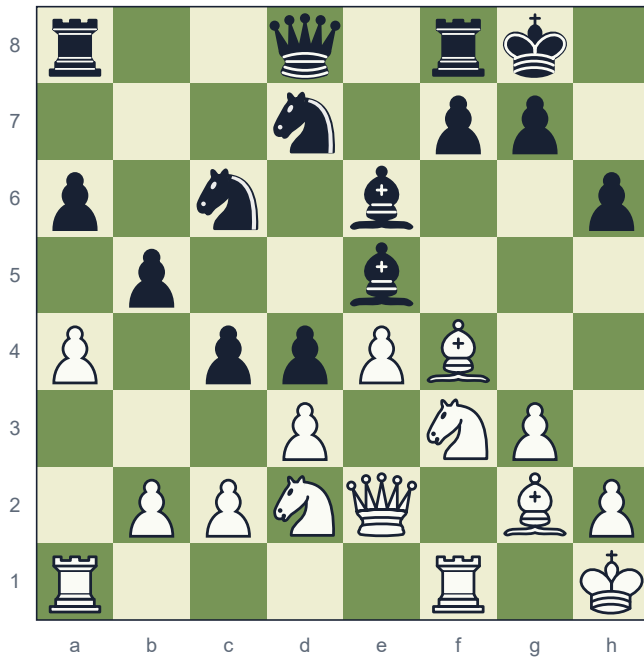
The pawn captures a pawn on e5. Calculate the best reply before assuming a recapture, then recount material and opened lines.

REASSESS

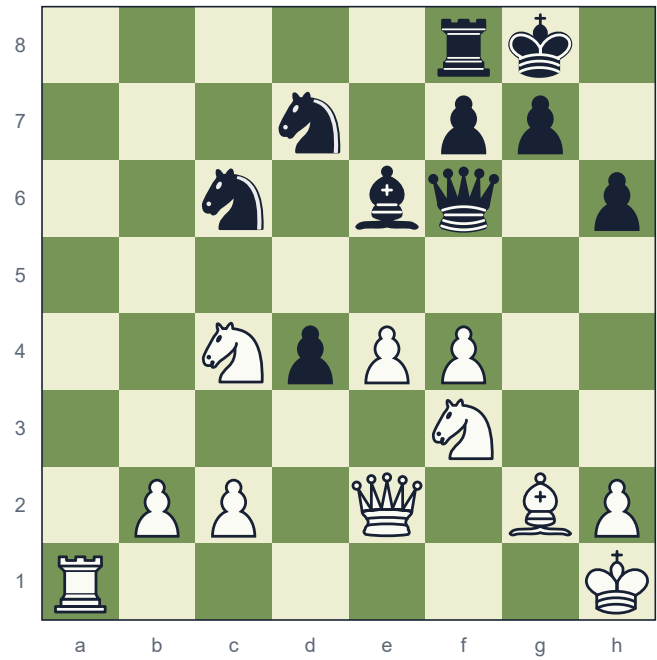
Name the material balance, the most active piece and the next pawn break. If the center changed, explain why the original plan may need to change too.

KIA-LAB-04 / play and explain 2

16. axb5 axb5 17. dxc4 Rxa1 18. Rxa1 bxc4 19. Nxc4 Bxf4 20. gxf4 Qf6



Before this segment - White to move



After this segment - White to move

16. AXB5

The pawn captures a pawn on b5. Calculate the best reply before assuming a recapture, then recount material and opened lines.

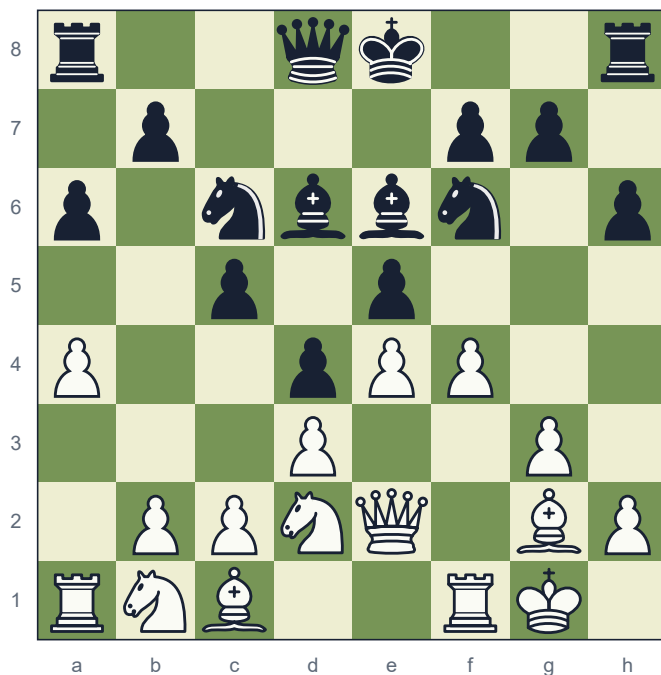
18. RXA1

The rook captures a rook on a1. Calculate the best reply before assuming a recapture, then recount material and opened lines.

REASSESS

Name the material balance, the most active piece and the next pawn break. If the center changed, explain why the original plan may need to change too.

KIA-LAB-04 / decision 1



White to move

COMPARE CANDIDATES

Kh1 and Nf3. Before reading the continuations, explain a useful purpose for each and calculate the opponent's most forcing reply.

CURRENT POSITION

White king g1; central-file pawns c2, d3, e4, f4. Black king e8; central-file pawns d4, c5, e5, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

CANDIDATE KH1

11. Kh1 b5 12. Nf3 c4 13. fxe5 Bxe5 14. axb5 axb5 Search estimate: -0.31 from White's perspective.

CANDIDATE NF3

11. Nf3 b5 12. Nxe5 Nxe5 13. fxe5 Bxe5 14. Bf4 Nd7 Search estimate: -0.33 from White's perspective.

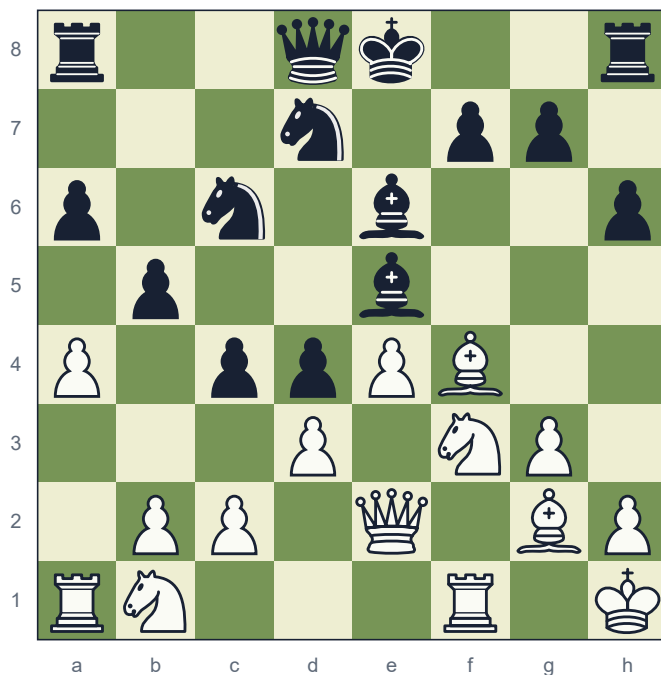
EXPLAIN THE PREFERRED MOVE

Places the king on h1. Compare its activity and safety with its previous square, then use the branch explanation to connect the move to a plan.

HOW TO INTERPRET THIS

The scores compare these candidates in one finite search. Close values mean the explanation and practical comfort matter; they do not imply a unique winning move. Replay both lines and identify the first concrete difference.

KIA-LAB-04 / decision 2



COMPARE CANDIDATES

Nbd2 and axb5. Before reading the continuations, explain a useful purpose for each and calculate the opponent's most forcing reply.

CURRENT POSITION

White king h1; central-file pawns c2, d3, e4. Black king e8; central-file pawns c4, d4, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

CANDIDATE NBD2

15. Nbd2 O-O 16. dxc4 bxa4 17. Rxa4 f6 18. b4 a5 Search estimate: -0.04 from White's perspective.

CANDIDATE AXB5

15. axb5 axb5 Search estimate: -0.28 from White's perspective.

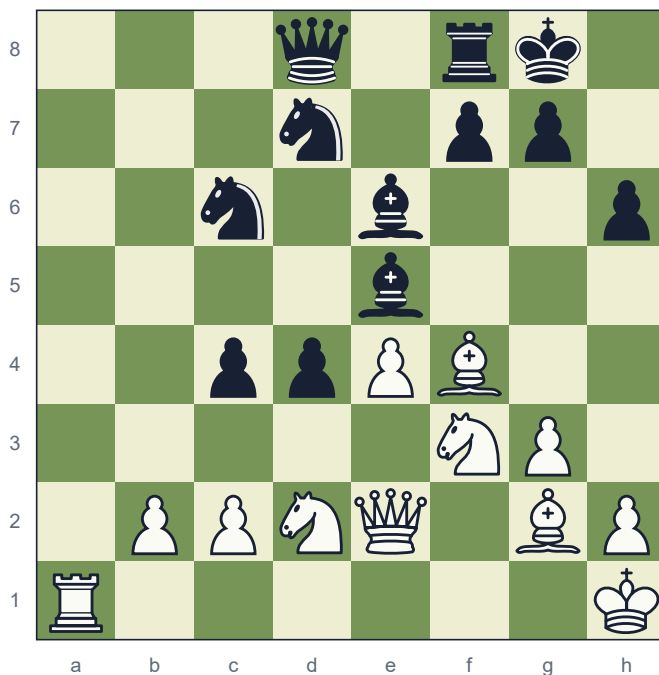
EXPLAIN THE PREFERRED MOVE

Develops the queen knight while leaving the c-pawn free. The knight supports e4 and may seek c4 or a route through f1.

HOW TO INTERPRET THIS

The scores compare these candidates in one finite search. Close values mean the explanation and practical comfort matter; they do not imply a unique winning move. Replay both lines and identify the first concrete difference.

KIA-LAB-04 / decision 3



White to move

COMPARE CANDIDATES

Nxc4 and Rg1. Before reading the continuations, explain a useful purpose for each and calculate the opponent's most forcing reply.

CURRENT POSITION

White king h1; central-file pawns c2, e4. Black king g8; central-file pawns c4, d4, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

CANDIDATE NXC4

19. Nxc4 Bxf4 20. gxf4 Qf6 21. f5 Bxc4 22. Qxc4 Rd8 Search estimate: -0.01 from White's perspective.

CANDIDATE RG1

19. Rg1 c3 Search estimate: -0.71 from White's perspective.

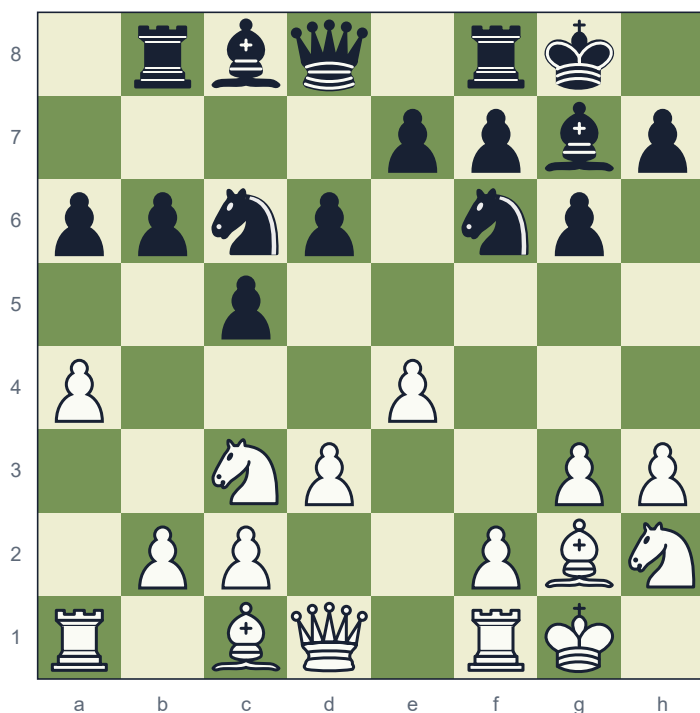
EXPLAIN THE PREFERRED MOVE

The knight captures a pawn on c4. Calculate the best reply before assuming a recapture, then recount material and opened lines.

HOW TO INTERPRET THIS

The scores compare these candidates in one finite search. Close values mean the explanation and practical comfort matter; they do not imply a unique winning move. Replay both lines and identify the first concrete difference.

KIA-LAB-05 / Black plays ...c5 on move one



Laboratory start - White to move

OPENING BACKGROUND

Starting with Nf3 allows Black a Sicilian-like or English-like structure. White can establish e4 after seeing Black's fianchetto.

READ THE CURRENT POSITION

White king g1; central-file pawns c2, f2, d3, e4. Black king g8; central-file pawns c5, d6, e7, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

OPENING CONCERN TO RECHECK

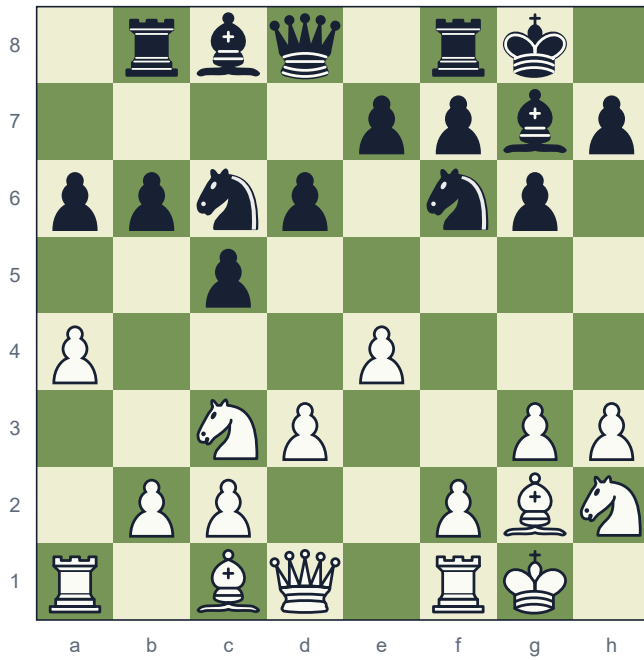
Nc3 blocks the c-pawn temporarily, while Nbd2 can crowd the queen bishop. Each knight square carries a structural commitment. Decide which parts still apply after the moves already played.

BEFORE PLAYING

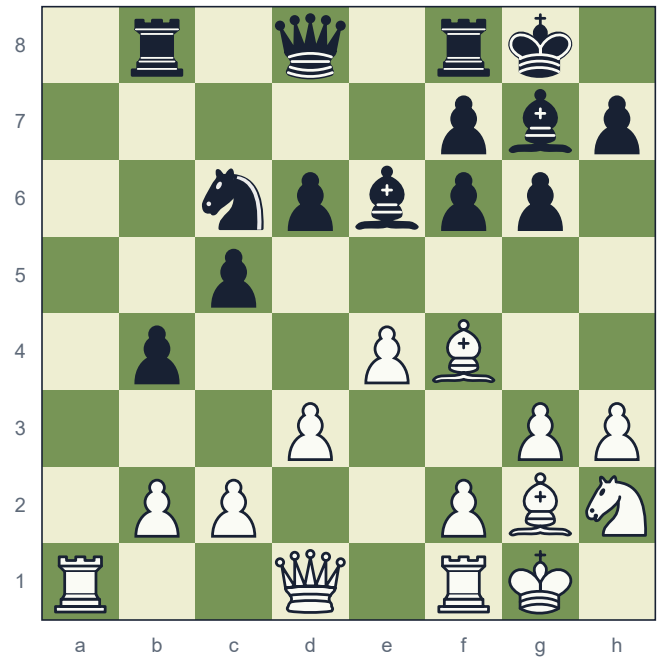
Write a candidate move and a reply for the opponent. Name the pawn break each side would like to achieve. The continuation on the following pages is one checked illustration, not a forced script.

KIA-LAB-05 / play and explain 1

11. Nd5 b5 12. axb5 axb5 13. Bg5 b4 14. Nxf6+ exf6 15. Bf4 Be6



Before this segment - White to move



After this segment - White to move

11. ND5

Places the knight on d5, attacking knight on f6. A legal capture may still be unsound if the target is defended.

13. BG5

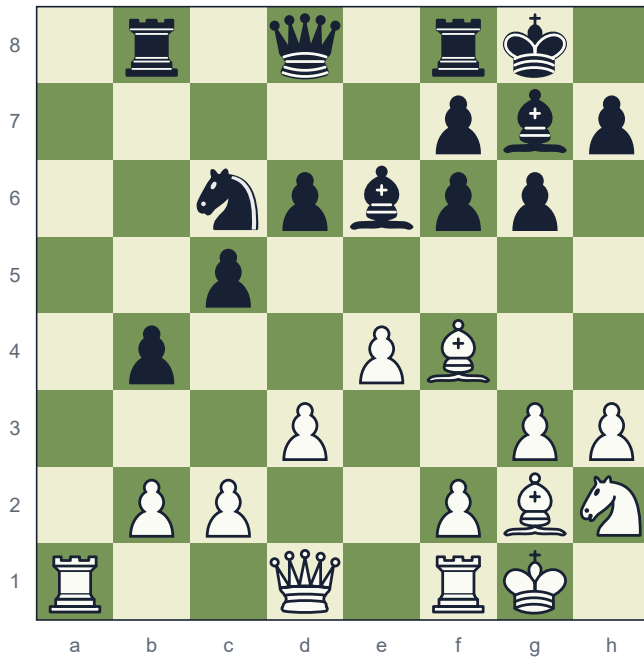
Places the bishop on g5, attacking knight on f6. A legal capture may still be unsound if the target is defended.

REASSESS

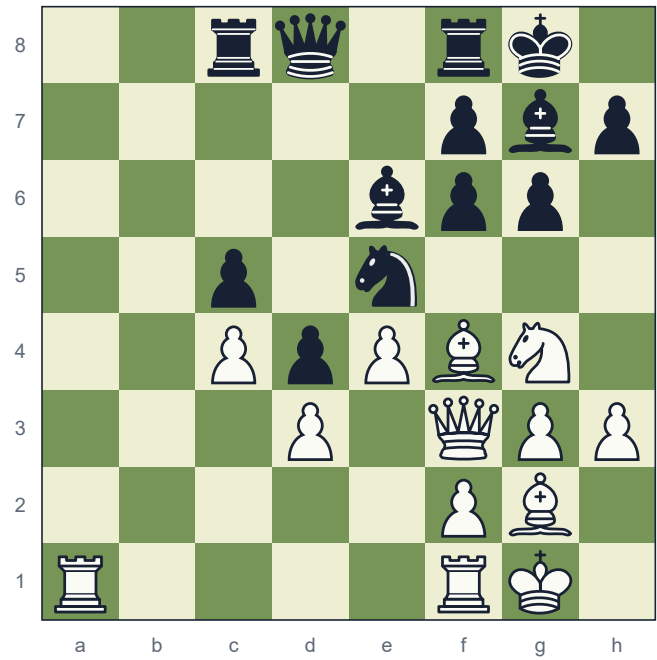
Name the material balance, the most active piece and the next pawn break. If the center changed, explain why the original plan may need to change too.

KIA-LAB-05 / play and explain 2

16. c3 Rc8 17. Ng4 d5 18. Qf3 bxc3 19. bxc3 d4 20. c4 Ne5



Before this segment - White to move



After this segment - White to move

16. C3

Places the pawn on c3. Compare its activity and safety with its previous square, then use the branch explanation to connect the move to a plan.

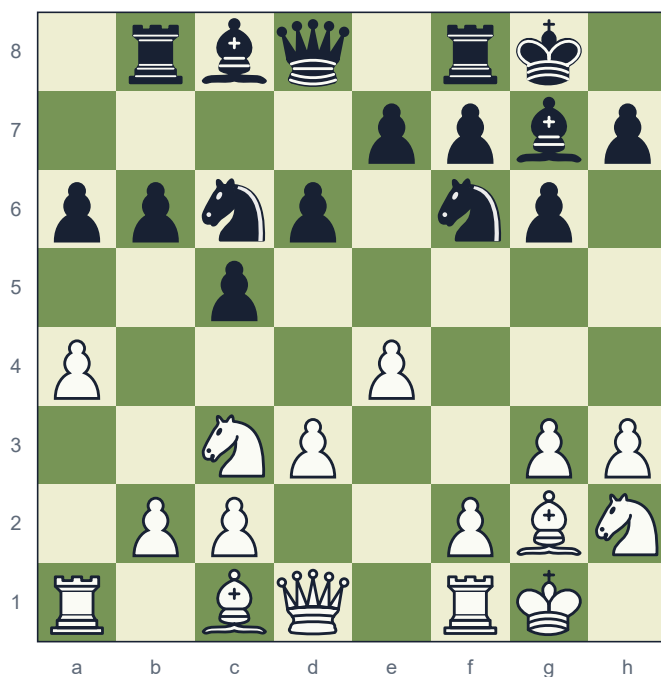
18. QF3

Places the queen on f3. Compare its activity and safety with its previous square, then use the branch explanation to connect the move to a plan.

REASSESS

Name the material balance, the most active piece and the next pawn break. If the center changed, explain why the original plan may need to change too.

KIA-LAB-05 / decision 1



White to move

COMPARE CANDIDATES

Nd5 and Bg5. Before reading the continuations, explain a useful purpose for each and calculate the opponent's most forcing reply.

CURRENT POSITION

White king g1; central-file pawns c2, f2, d3, e4. Black king g8; central-file pawns c5, d6, e7, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

CANDIDATE ND5

11. Nd5 b5 12. axb5 axb5 13. Bg5 b4 14. Nxf6+ Bxf6 Search estimate: -0.15 from White's perspective.

CANDIDATE BG5

11. Bg5 h6 Search estimate: -0.23 from White's perspective.

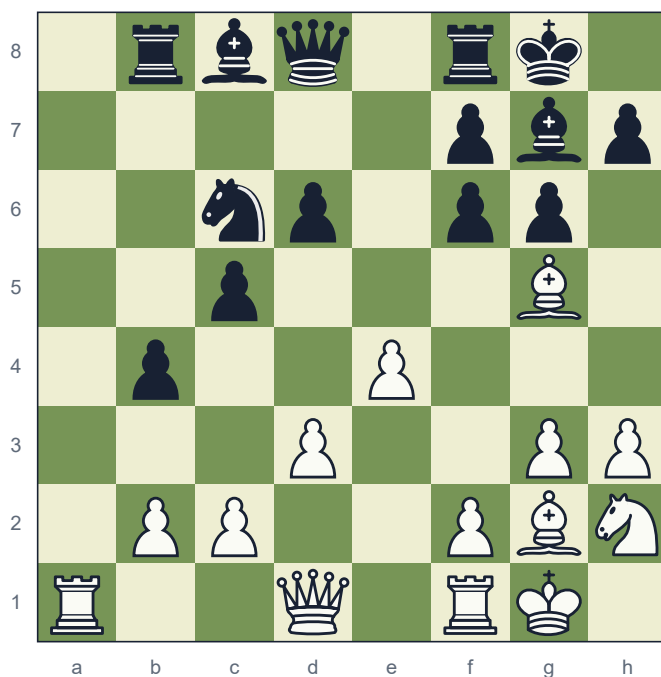
EXPLAIN THE PREFERRED MOVE

Places the knight on d5, attacking knight on f6. A legal capture may still be unsound if the target is defended.

HOW TO INTERPRET THIS

The scores compare these candidates in one finite search. Close values mean the explanation and practical comfort matter; they do not imply a unique winning move. Replay both lines and identify the first concrete difference.

KIA-LAB-05 / decision 2



COMPARE CANDIDATES

Bf4 and Be3. Before reading the continuations, explain a useful purpose for each and calculate the opponent's most forcing reply.

CURRENT POSITION

White king g1; central-file pawns c2, f2, d3, e4. Black king g8; central-file pawns c5, d6, f6, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

CANDIDATE BF4

15. Bf4 Search estimate: -0.02 from White's perspective.

CANDIDATE BE3

15. Be3 Qb6 16. Bf4 Ne5 17. Qd2 Search estimate: -0.09 from White's perspective.

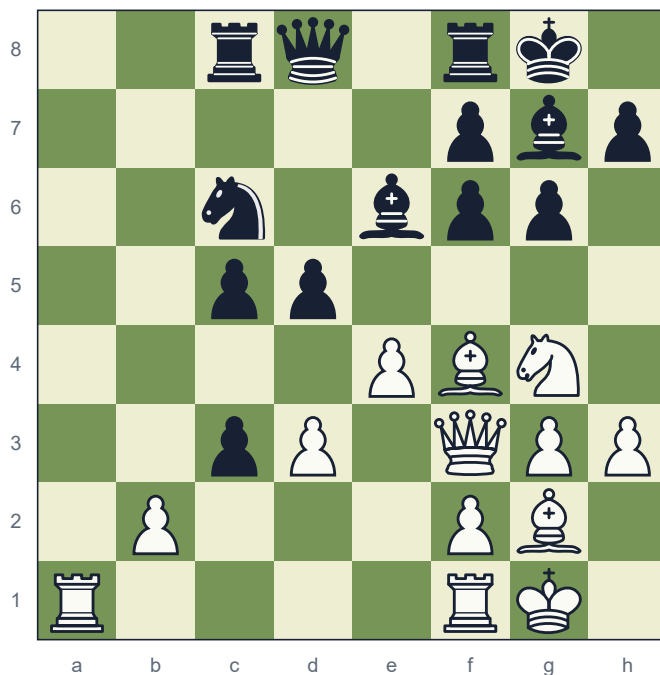
EXPLAIN THE PREFERRED MOVE

Develops the queen bishop with central influence. Check whether a pawn advance can gain a tempo against it.

HOW TO INTERPRET THIS

The scores compare these candidates in one finite search. Close values mean the explanation and practical comfort matter; they do not imply a unique winning move. Replay both lines and identify the first concrete difference.

KIA-LAB-05 / decision 3



COMPARE CANDIDATES

bxc3 and Nh6+. Before reading the continuations, explain a useful purpose for each and calculate the opponent's most forcing reply.

CURRENT POSITION

White king g1; central-file pawns f2, d3, e4. Black king g8; central-file pawns c3, c5, d5, f6, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

CANDIDATE BXC3

19. bxc3 Search estimate: -0.12 from White's perspective.

CANDIDATE NH6+

19. Nh6+ Bxh6 20. Bxh6 Nd4 21. Qe3 c2 22. Bxf8 Kxf8 Search estimate: -2.10 from White's perspective.

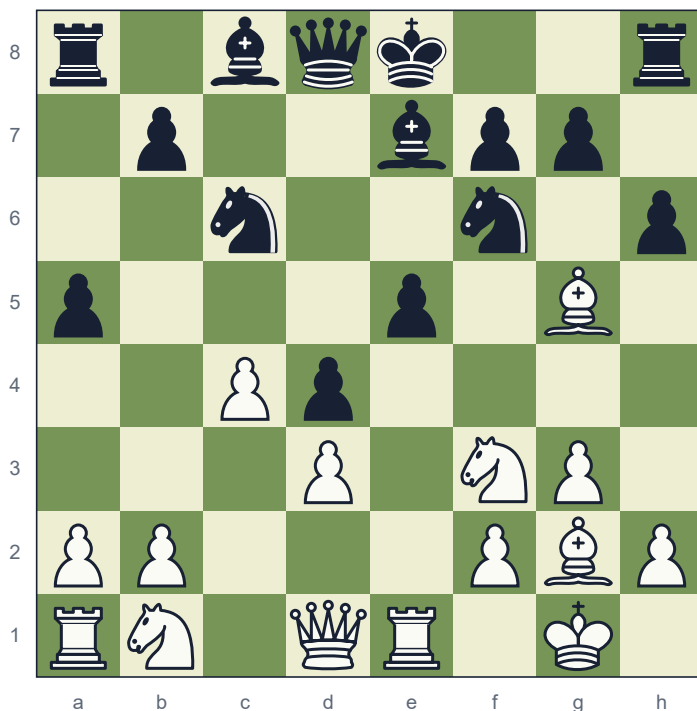
EXPLAIN THE PREFERRED MOVE

The pawn captures a pawn on c3. Calculate the best reply before assuming a recapture, then recount material and opened lines.

HOW TO INTERPRET THIS

The scores compare these candidates in one finite search. Close values mean the explanation and practical comfort matter; they do not imply a unique winning move. Replay both lines and identify the first concrete difference.

KIA-LAB-06 / Early ...d4 before the setup



Laboratory start - White to move

OPENING BACKGROUND

White chooses c4 before e4 to challenge the broad center. Once Black closes with ...d4, the result belongs to a different structure from the main KIA attack.

READ THE CURRENT POSITION

White king g1; central-file pawns f2, d3, c4. Black king e8; central-file pawns d4, e5, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

OPENING CONCERN TO RECHECK

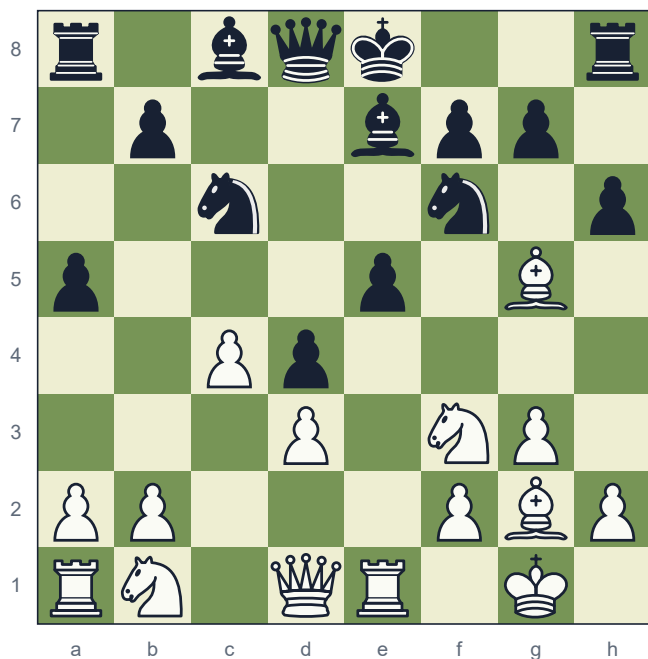
Black's d4 pawn restricts Nc3. Putting a piece on a square controlled by that pawn is a concrete error, regardless of a familiar development pattern. Decide which parts still apply after the moves already played.

BEFORE PLAYING

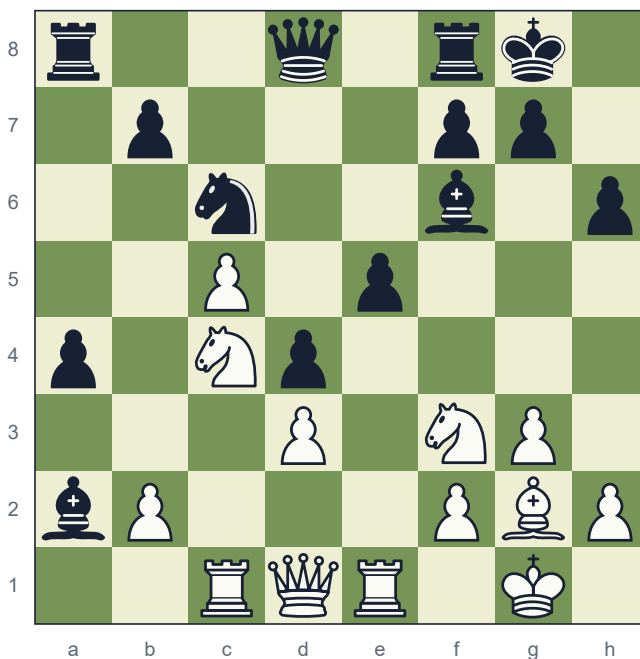
Write a candidate move and a reply for the opponent. Name the pawn break each side would like to achieve. The continuation on the following pages is one checked illustration, not a forced script.

KIA-LAB-06 / play and explain 1

11. Bxf6 Bxf6 12. c5 Be6 13. Na3 a4 14. Rc1 Bxa2 15. Nc4 O-O



Before this segment - White to move



After this segment - White to move

11. Bxf6

The bishop captures a knight on f6. Calculate the best reply before assuming a recapture, then recount material and opened lines.

13. NA3

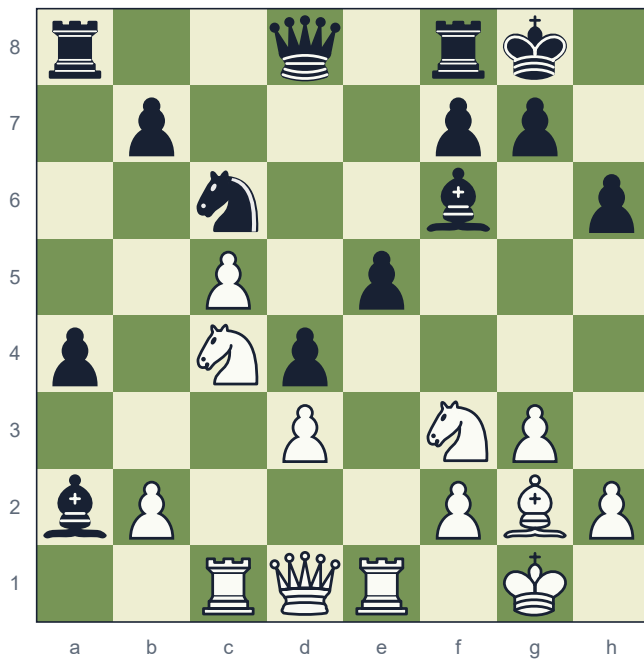
Places the knight on a3. Compare its activity and safety with its previous square, then use the branch explanation to connect the move to a plan.

REASSESS

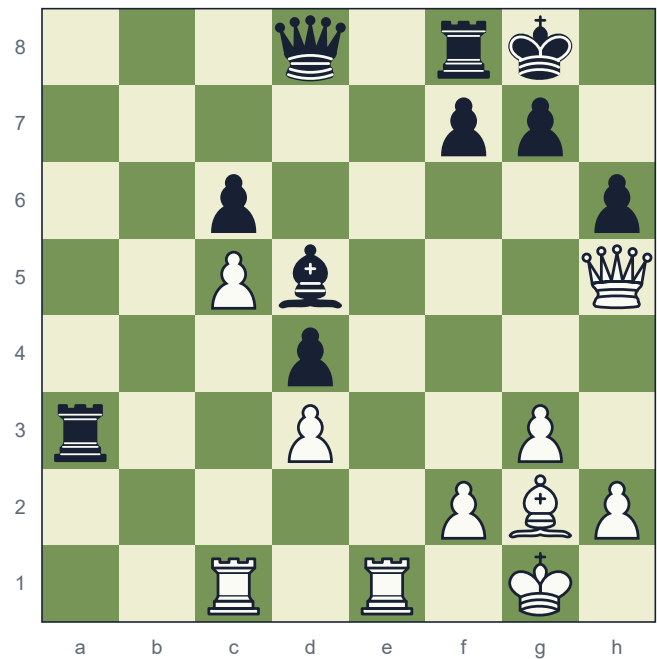
Name the material balance, the most active piece and the next pawn break. If the center changed, explain why the original plan may need to change too.

KIA-LAB-06 / play and explain 2

16. Nfxe5 Bxe5 17. Nxe5 Bd5 18. Nxc6 bxc6 19. Qh5 a3 20. bxa3 Rxa3



Before this segment - White to move



After this segment - White to move

16. NFXE5

The knight captures a pawn on e5. Calculate the best reply before assuming a recapture, then recount material and opened lines.

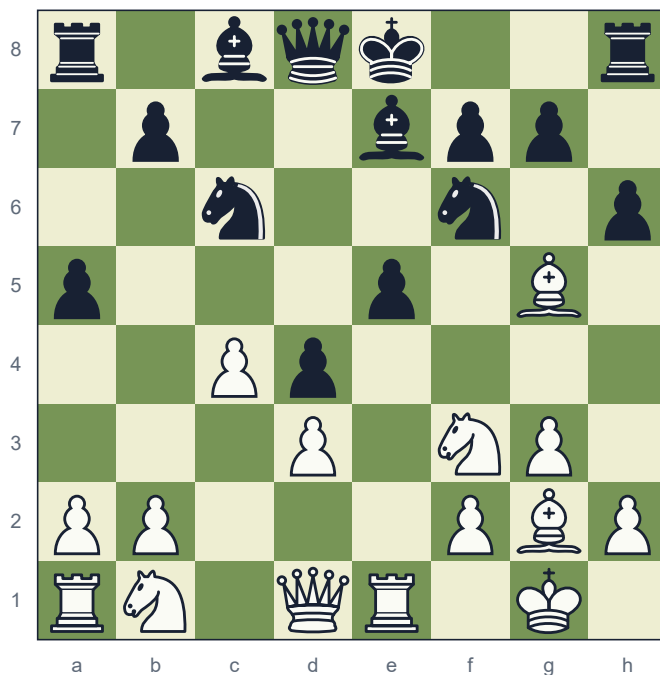
18. NXC6

The knight captures a knight on c6. Calculate the best reply before assuming a recapture, then recount material and opened lines.

REASSESS

Name the material balance, the most active piece and the next pawn break. If the center changed, explain why the original plan may need to change too.

KIA-LAB-06 / decision 1



White to move

COMPARE CANDIDATES

Bxf6 and Bc1. Before reading the continuations, explain a useful purpose for each and calculate the opponent's most forcing reply.

CURRENT POSITION

White king g1; central-file pawns f2, d3, c4. Black king e8; central-file pawns d4, e5, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

CANDIDATE BXF6

11. Bxf6 Search estimate: +0.25 from White's perspective.

CANDIDATE BC1

11. Bc1 Nd7 12. Na3 O-O 13. Nb5 Re8 14. a3 a4 Search estimate: -0.78 from White's perspective.

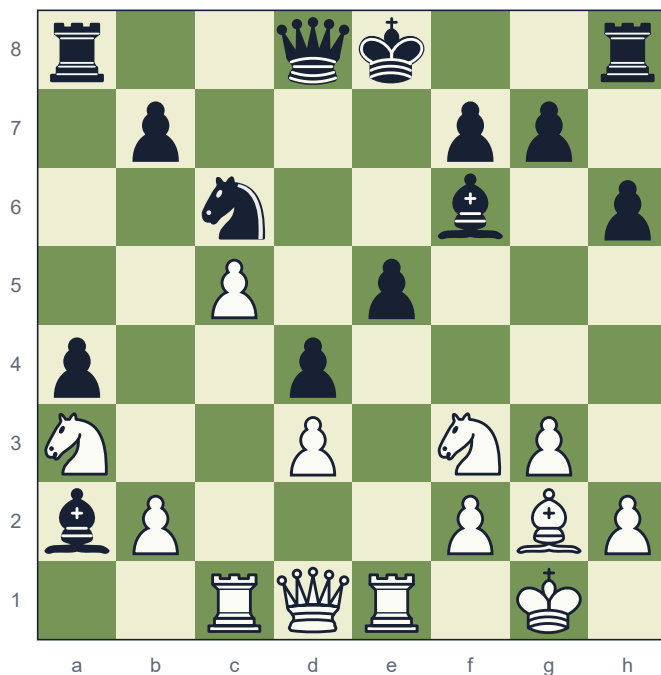
EXPLAIN THE PREFERRED MOVE

The bishop captures a knight on f6. Calculate the best reply before assuming a recapture, then recount material and opened lines.

HOW TO INTERPRET THIS

The scores compare these candidates in one finite search. Close values mean the explanation and practical comfort matter; they do not imply a unique winning move. Replay both lines and identify the first concrete difference.

KIA-LAB-06 / decision 2



COMPARE CANDIDATES

Nc4 and Nd2. Before reading the continuations, explain a useful purpose for each and calculate the opponent's most forcing reply.

CURRENT POSITION

White king g1; central-file pawns f2, d3, c5. Black king e8; central-file pawns d4, e5, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

CANDIDATE NC4

15. Nc4 O-O 16. Nfxe5 Bxe5 17. Nxe5 Bd5 18. Nxc6 bxc6 Search estimate: +0.06 from White's perspective.

CANDIDATE ND2

15. Nd2 Search estimate: -0.08 from White's perspective.

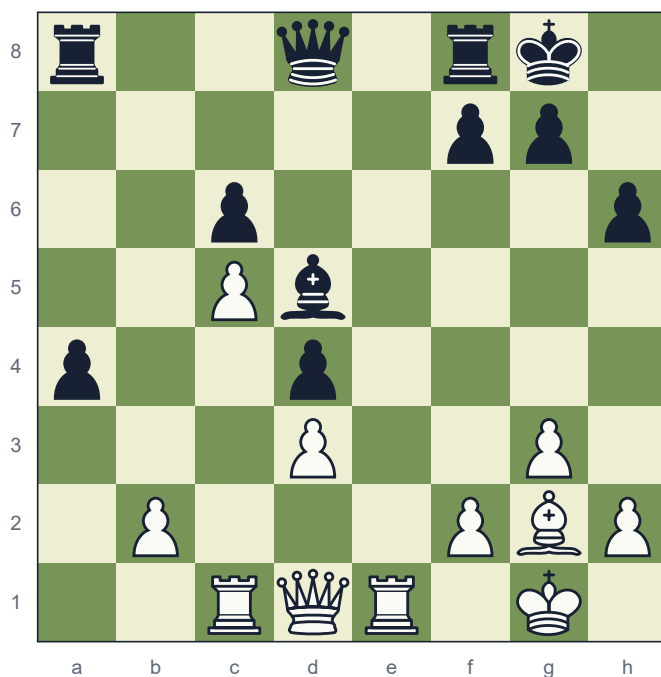
EXPLAIN THE PREFERRED MOVE

Places the knight on c4. Compare its activity and safety with its previous square, then use the branch explanation to connect the move to a plan.

HOW TO INTERPRET THIS

The scores compare these candidates in one finite search. Close values mean the explanation and practical comfort matter; they do not imply a unique winning move. Replay both lines and identify the first concrete difference.

KIA-LAB-06 / decision 3



White to move

COMPARE CANDIDATES

Qh5 and Re5. Before reading the continuations, explain a useful purpose for each and calculate the opponent's most forcing reply.

CURRENT POSITION

White king g1; central-file pawns f2, d3, c5. Black king g8; central-file pawns d4, c6, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

CANDIDATE QH5

19. Qh5 a3 20. bxa3 Rxa3 21. Bxd5 Qxd5 22. Re5 Qb3 Search estimate: +0.07 from White's perspective.

CANDIDATE RE5

19. Re5 Bxg2 20. Kxg2 f6 21. Re4 f5 22. Re5 f4 Search estimate: +0.01 from White's perspective.

EXPLAIN THE PREFERRED MOVE

Places the queen on h5, attacking bishop on d5. A legal capture may still be unsound if the target is defended.

HOW TO INTERPRET THIS

The scores compare these candidates in one finite search. Close values mean the explanation and practical comfort matter; they do not imply a unique winning move. Replay both lines and identify the first concrete difference.